EASYCUT

CREATOR PLAYBOOK / 04



ENGLISH / US EDITION

The Practical Short-Video Monetization Guide

A practical guide to editing long-form videos into short-form content and monetizing on YouTube Shorts, Instagram Reels, and TikTok.

AI-generated illustrative creator

20 PAGES / 2026 EDITION

Who Is This Guide For?

This is a practical handbook for creators who want to edit long-form videos into short-form content using Easy Cut, and then publish and monetize them on YouTube, Instagram, and TikTok.

Key Takeaway
Editing a video extensively does not automatically resolve copyright issues or guarantee monetization. You need both the right to use the content and genuine creative value.

What You Will Learn in This Book
- The rights you need when using someone else's long-form video
- Types of high-risk content you must avoid
- The difference between simple re-editing and monetizable creative work
- How monetization works on YouTube, Instagram, and TikTok
- How to manage all three platforms with a single production
- The final checklist before uploading your content

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How Does Short-Form Content Make Money?

PART 1
Basics of Short-Form Monetization

How does short-form content generate income?

Revenue from short-form content is not limited to ad views. The actual income structure includes platform ads, viewer gifts, paid subscriptions, brand sponsorships, affiliate marketing, and selling your own products.

Examples of Monetization Methods
- Platform Ads: YouTube Shorts ad revenue sharing, TikTok Creator Rewards
- Viewer Support: Instagram Gifts, TikTok Video/LIVE Gifts
- Subscriptions: Instagram Subscriptions, YouTube Memberships
- Brand Sponsorships: Branded content, partnership ads, TikTok One
- External Sales: Affiliate links, ebooks, courses, services, editing gigs

Copyright and Monetization Are Separate Issues

CORE RULE
Copyright and monetization are completely different issues.

1. Copyright
You must determine whether you have the rights to copy, edit, publish, and monetize the video. Just because a video is available online does not mean you are free to reuse it.

2. Platform Monetization Policy
The platform will judge whether your content is original and authentic. Even if you have the original creator's permission, videos with only minimal changes may be classified as reused content and restricted from monetization.

You must clear both hurdles:
① The right to use the video + ② A meaningful difference that viewers can recognize

Citing the Source Is Not Permission
- Writing "Source: Original Channel" does not grant you usage rights.
- Phrases like "No copyright infringement intended" do not create rights.
- There is no official rule that using only a few seconds is always safe.

Which Long-Form Videos Are Safe to Use?

PART 2
Which long-form videos should you use?

Safest Options (in order):
- Videos you made yourself and own all the rights to
- Videos where you have a contract with the original creator for short-form production, commercial use, and platform posting
- Licensed videos that clearly allow commercial use and modification
- Videos used only as much as necessary for criticism, analysis, or education

When Getting Permission, Check These Points:
- Whether you can edit, modify, and create short-form content
- Whether you can post on YouTube, Instagram, and TikTok
- Whether commercial use is allowed, including ads, sponsorships, and affiliate links
- Duration, countries, number of productions, and revenue sharing
- Responsibility for handling rights to music, stock footage, and appearances by people in the video

High-Risk Content to Avoid

HIGH RISK
Content You Should Avoid Without Proper Authorization

Video/Broadcast: Movies, TV dramas, variety shows, animation, and OTT (streaming) scenes
Sports: Soccer, baseball, basketball, combat sports, and e-sports broadcasts or highlights
Music: Music videos, concerts, music shows, and videos centered on commercial music tracks
Reuploads: Other people’s Shorts, Reels, or TikTok videos, or videos with watermarks
Sensitive Content: Minors, accidents, crime, medical incidents, leaked or deleted videos
Paid Content: Courses, memberships, internal corporate training, private seminars

Caution:
"Other channels are uploading it," "It's shorter than the original," or "I removed the watermark" are NOT valid reasons for safety.

What Makes Monetizable Editing Different?

PART 3
How Is Monetizable Editing Different?

Editing Techniques Alone Are Not Enough
- 9:16 vertical cropping
- Auto captions and word highlights
- Speaker tracking and zoom-ins
- Background music, sound effects, progress bars
- Hooking titles and emojis
- Speed, color, and horizontal flip adjustments

These techniques improve the viewing experience, but if they simply deliver the original’s purpose and core value, they are unlikely to be recognized as new content.

Creating New Value
- Explain the background and context of statements
- Analyze, counter, or fact-check key claims
- Compare different cases or data
- Reconstruct for educational clarity, especially for beginners
- Add your own experience, conclusions, or actionable steps

Recommended Shorts Structure

FORMAT
Recommended Shorts Structure

Section Roles
0-3 sec: Pose a problem or create curiosity about the conclusion
3-8 sec: Briefly present original statements needed for analysis
8-25 sec: Creator explains background, context, and terms
25-45 sec: Present additional evidence, counterpoints, or comparison cases
45-60 sec: Creator’s conclusion and suggested next steps

Judgment Question
Are viewers consuming this video as a short copy of the original, or as a separate piece with the creator’s new explanations and perspective?

YouTube Shorts Monetization Requirements

PART 4
YouTube Shorts Monetization

Eligibility for Ad Revenue Sharing
Shorts-Focused Path:
- At least 1,000 subscribers AND 10 million valid public Shorts views in the last 90 days

Long-Form Path:
- At least 1,000 subscribers AND 4,000 valid public watch hours in the last 12 months

Meeting these requirements does NOT mean automatic approval. Your entire channel will undergo a separate review to ensure it meets all YouTube monetization policies. Shorts feed watch time does NOT count toward the 4,000-hour threshold.

Expanded Early Access YPP (where available):
- At least 500 subscribers
- At least 3 public uploads in the last 90 days
- Either 3,000 valid public watch hours in the last 12 months OR 3 million valid public Shorts views in the last 90 days

This stage grants early access to some features like fan funding and shopping, but is NOT the final threshold for Shorts ad revenue sharing.

Common Reasons for YouTube Monetization Denial

YOUTUBE
Common Reasons for Monetization Denial on YouTube
- Repeatedly posting minimally edited content from others
- Compilations of movies, sports, or social media clips without a narrative
- Mass-produced, repetitive content using similar templates
- Channels where the creator’s participation and added value are unclear
- Content lacking commercial rights for all audio-visual elements

Important:
The reused content policy is separate from copyright permission. Even if the original creator allows use, YouTube may still restrict monetization if it does not see a "meaningful difference."

Ways to Earn on YouTube
- Shorts Feed ad revenue
- YouTube Premium revenue sharing
- Super Thanks, memberships, and live stream support
- YouTube Shopping and affiliate partnerships
- Brand sponsorships, external products, and services

Instagram Reels Monetization Overview

PART 5
Instagram Reels Monetization

Instagram does not have a single ad revenue threshold that applies to all accounts like YouTube. Available monetization features depend on your country, account, and program eligibility.

Main Monetization Methods
- Reels Gifts: Viewers send virtual gifts on Reels
- Subscriptions: Offer exclusive Reels, Stories, or Lives for subscribers
- Brand sponsorships and branded content
- Partnership ads: Brands use creator content in their ads
- Affiliate links and selling your own products or services

How to Check Eligibility
Go to your Instagram profile → Professional Dashboard → Monetization Status to see which features and qualifications are available for your account.

Operational Tips
- Maintain a professional account and good account standing
- Clearly disclose paid partnerships or product gifts
- Specify the duration and scope of brand ad reuse in contracts
- Availability of Gifts, subscriptions, and bonuses may vary by country and account

TikTok Monetization: Key Requirements

Creator Rewards Program - Main Requirements
- A personal account in good standing registered in a supported country
- At least 18 years old in the US
- At least 10,000 followers
- At least 100,000 video views in the last 30 days
- Posting original, eligible videos longer than 1 minute

Why Video Length Matters
If you want to qualify for Creator Rewards, just making 15-30 second clips isn't enough. You need to create separate, fully developed explanatory content that is at least 60-90 seconds long.

Additional Earning Methods
- Video Gifts: Viewers can send gifts on regular videos
- LIVE Gifts: Gifts and Diamonds during live streams
- TikTok One: Collaborate with brands and advertisers
- Affiliate marketing, selling your own products or services

TikTok: Content Originality & TikTok One Entry

Examples of Videos That May Lack Originality on TikTok
- Videos downloaded from other platforms with visible watermarks
- Clips focused on scenes from movies, TV shows, or broadcasts
- Compilations made by stitching together other people’s videos
- Content that only changes subtitles, speed, or filters
- Videos where the original clip dominates and the creator adds little explanation

Typical Entry Criteria for TikTok One
- Account in good standing
- At least 18 years old, or the regional minimum age
- Around 10,000 followers
- At least 1,000 views on posts in the last 30 days
- At least 3 posts in the last 30 days

Details may vary by region, so always check the TikTok Studio or TikTok One menu in the app for your current requirements.

Managing Three Platforms with One Edit

Start with a Master File Without Watermarks
- Use 9:16 aspect ratio, 1080×1920 resolution
- No platform logos or watermarks
- Place captions in safe areas so they don’t overlap with top/bottom UI
- Use music that is licensed for commercial use
- Keep your project files and proof of rights together

What Needs to Change for Each Platform
Editing Points by Platform
- YouTube: Searchable titles, consistent channel theme, encourage repeat viewing
- Instagram: Focus on save/share value, captions, profile and product links
- TikTok: Get to the point from the first frame, encourage comments, make a 1-minute-plus version for Rewards

EasyCut Practical Workflow

1. Rights Check
Decide first whether you are using your own content, have a contract/license, or are relying on fair use.

2. AI Segment Selection
Don’t just cut out the fun parts-select segments needed for analysis or explanation.

3. Add New Value
Include narration, analysis, examples, data, counterpoints, or conclusions.

4. Make Platform-Specific Versions
Adjust length and purpose for YouTube, Instagram, and TikTok as needed.

5. Analyze After Upload
Check completion rate, repeat views, saves, shares, comments, and conversion rates to improve your next video.

Final Pre-Upload Checklist

Rights
☐ Verified the actual rights holder
☐ Editing, modification, and commercial use are allowed
☐ Checked rights for music, stock footage, and anyone appearing in the video
☐ Kept proof of permissions, contracts, or licenses

Originality
☐ The video is not just cropped or subtitled
☐ My own commentary, analysis, or new information is the focus
☐ Only the minimum necessary amount of original material is used
☐ The original's core appeal and market are not replaced

Platform
☐ Checked for YouTube reused/repetitive content risks
☐ Verified Instagram monetization status in the dashboard
☐ For TikTok Rewards, ensured the original content is over 1 minute
☐ Uploading watermark-free files to each platform

If you're unsure about any item, pause uploading. Confirm with the rights holder or reduce your use of the original material, and strengthen your own explanations and new information.

FAQ: Short-Form Monetization Questions

Frequently Asked Questions
Q. Is it okay if I only use 10 seconds?
A. No. There is no official rule that any specific number of seconds is always safe.

Q. Can I use content if I credit the source?
A. Citing the source is not the same as having permission to use the content.

Q. If I add speaker tracking and subtitles, is it new content?
A. These are editing conveniences; by themselves, they do not create new purpose or commentary.

Q. If I get permission from the original creator, can I monetize on YouTube?
A. Permission reduces copyright risk, but you still have to pass YouTube’s reused content review.

Q. Can I upload the same video to all three platforms?
A. Yes, but it’s best to start from a master file without any platform’s watermark, and adjust length, wording, and music for each platform.

Q. If AI edits my video, who is responsible?
A. The person who uploads and monetizes the video is ultimately responsible for rights and policy compliance.

Official sources

Open a title to read the official guidance. Recheck current terms before applying or publishing.

YouTube Partner Program Overview and Eligibility
support.google.com

YouTube Expanded YPP
support.google.com

YouTube Channel Monetization Policies
support.google.com

YouTube Shorts Monetization Policies
support.google.com

Instagram Monetization Tools Eligibility
help.instagram.com

Instagram Partner Monetization Policies
help.instagram.com

Instagram Gifts
help.instagram.com

Instagram Subscriptions
help.instagram.com

TikTok Creator Rewards Program
support.tiktok.com

TikTok Video Gifts
support.tiktok.com

TikTok One
support.tiktok.com

FTC Disclosures for Social Media Influencers
ftc.gov

US Copyright Fair Use
copyright.gov

Amazon Associates Program
affiliate-program.amazon.com

What Makes a Good Short-Form Video?

A great short-form video isn't just a trimmed copy of the original-it's a video that creates new value from the source material.

EASY CUT
Long-form to short-form, made easy.